

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ K Q J 10
♦ Q J 10 2
♣ 10 7 3

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 9 5 2

♦ K 9

♣ 9 8 6 2



♠ 10 8
♥ A 6 4 3
♦ 8 5 4 3
♣ A K J

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4

SOUTH has an opening hand, 15 points, and a 5-card ♠ suit. Unfortunately EAST beat her to the punch by opening 1♥.

But SOUTH should get into the bidding anyway, by Overcalling 1♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

NORTH has 6 points. If SOUTH had actually OPENED 1♠, NORTH would be obligated to bid. But knowing that the Overcall will not be made with more than 16 points, NORTH just passes.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

1♠

All Pass

1♠ by South

Lead: ♦Q

Board 2

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8
 ♥ A K J 9
 ♦ J 9 8
 ♣ 8 7 3 2

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 10 5 2

♦ K Q 4

♣ K J 6



♠ 5 3

♥ Q 6 4 3

♦ 10 5 3 2

♣ A 10 9

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4

West	North	East	South
		1 ♥	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥K			

SOUTH has an opening hand, 15 points and five ♠s.
 But EAST beat him to the punch, so he overcalls 1 ♠.

NORTH has 11 points, and if SOUTH had opened
 she would make a Limit Raise to 3 ♠.

But when replying to an Overcall, the strength needs
 to be a little higher. In Deal 1 it was OK to pass a 1 ♠
 Overcall with 6 points, here it is correct to just raise
 to 2 ♠ with 11 points.

SOUTH actually has a strong Overcall so he bids
 4 ♠.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ A K J 3
♦ Q 10 3 2
♣ A 9 3

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 10 5 2

♦ A K

♣ K 8 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 8

♥ Q 9 6 4

♦ J 8 5 4

♣ Q 10 7

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ 9 7 6

♣ J 5 4

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

1♠

Pass

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by South

Lead: ♥A

This time SOUTH has just 10 points, nowhere near an opening hand. Still, when EAST opens 1♥ SOUTH should Overcall 1♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

NORTH has 13 points. If SOUTH had actually OPENED 1♠, NORTH would insist on game. But SOUTH didn't Open, she just Overcalled. So NORTH must be more cautious. He jumps to 3♠ and SOUTH shows her minimum type hand by passing.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 7 4 2
♥ Q 9 8 2
♦ 9 6 4 2
♣ J 10

♠ K 9 8 6

♥ 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ K Q 7 5



♠ Q J

♥ A K J 6 3

♦ J 10 5

♣ 9 4 3

♠ A 10 5 3

♥ 10 7 5

♦ Q 8

♣ A 8 6 2

NORTH has 15 points, a singleton in the opponent's suit and 4-card support for any suit partner might name. In other words, a perfect Takeout Double.

SOUTH needs to make a medium-strong bid to apprise NORTH of her 10 points. She jumps to 2♠.

NORTH's hand is now worth 17 points because of the singleton. Since he is quite happy with ♠s he bids 4♠.

West

1♥

Pass

All Pass

4♠ by South

Lead: ♦4

North

Dbl

4♠

East

Pass

South

2♠